Teacher Guide & Answers

Passage Reading Level: Lexile 1230

1. **B** work on a plantation in Maryland

2. **B** the life and political activism of Frederick Douglass

3. **C** After his master said that "learning would spoil" him, Douglass continued his education on his own.

4. **C** He was able to powerfully communicate his first-hand experience as a slave.

5. B Over the course of his life, Frederick Douglass went from being a slave to being a respected activist for abolition and equal rights.

6. **A** to immediately show readers that Frederick Douglass was a powerful voice in the abolition movement

7. **D** although

8. **Suggested answer**: Answers may vary but should mention an incident from Douglass's time as a slave. Students may mention that Douglass was separated from his family, suffered chronic hunger, or witnessed violence against his family, for example.

9. **Suggested answer**: Douglass's main political belief was that blacks should have political and social equality. He also demonstrated his belief in women's rights, including the right to vote.

10. **Suggested answer**: Answers may vary but should use evidence from the text as support. Douglass's childhood experience as a slave probably fostered a rebellious spirit and a desire for freedom that fueled his later fight for social and political equality. His exposure to and appreciation of education may also have contributed to this commitment to social equality for blacks. Students may argue that his positive experience with the woman who taught him to read could have influenced his views on women's rights as well. Advanced answers may note that Douglass's first-hand experience with slavery, violence, and discrimination may have urged him towards demanding full civil and political rights, rather than just economic advancement (like Booker T. Washington) or his earlier view which prioritized moral purity over political success; having lived through those horrors, he may have been driven to this more drastic goal for change.

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